



India Responds

LETTER CAMPAIGN

To deal urgently with burning issues in the war on terror, we now call on you to write directly to the Union Minister for Law and Justice and seek decisive action.

Honourable Minister,

I have joined the INDIA TODAY Group's movement to Declare War on Terror. A major issue is how to deal with the growing criminalisation straddling the political spectrum. If those who commit crimes are allowed to stand for elections because of legal loopholes, it brings disrespect to the law and encourages disruptive elements. I humbly request you to move an amendment to Section 8 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, to provide that any person who is prima facie charged by a competent judicial authority for an offence punishable by imprisonment for five years or more be disqualified from contesting an election. The war on terror must start with a political clean up and this amendment will go a long way in doing so.

Yours sincerely
Concerned Citizen of India
(Sign here)

Write to H.R. Bhardwaj on your letterhead and send it to:
Union Minister for Law and Justice
4th Floor, A-Wing, Shastri Bhawan, New Delhi-110 001 Or
email: hansrajb@sansad.nic.in
You can also go to www.indiatoday.in/war and send it from there.

Citizen's Charter: Other Ways You Can Help

Turn your concern into action. **FIVE** simple things you can do now, that can make a significant impact in our War on Terror:

1 MARKET WATCH

Check whether markets you go to are secure. Start a boycott campaign if they are not.

2 LEARN FIRST AID

Enroll in a first aid course so you can help in an emergency till medical professionals arrive.

3 BADGER YOUR MLA

Push your local MLA for more public security measures.

4 COMMUNITY WARDENS

Volunteer to help in policing your neighbourhood by reporting suspicious activities.

5 DONATE FREELY

Look out for genuine charities that are supporting victims of terror and donate generously.

Share your suggestions, Click to www.indiatoday.in/war or sms WAR with your suggestion, name and city to 52424



India's Views

I feel ashamed to think 10 terrorists can kill 180 people, injure 350, and cause such huge damage to property. That it took three days to eliminate them is shocking. We must train one person from each family in civil defence. Let's make two-year national defence compulsory for young people in the age-group of 18-25.

SURINDER KUMAR MINOCHA, *Surat*

The US had 9/11 almost eight years back. Since then it has been peaceful. In India, we see bloodshed and mayhem every month and we still stick to *ahimsa parmo dharma*. That era is over. We should reply as per the demands.

JOHN TAN, *Delhi*

We need to go to the roots. Cosmetic surgery won't do. We must break the backbone of terror—its financial and physical strength. Otherwise, attacks will keep happening. We need prevention rather than cure.

SURYAKANT THAKKAR, *Ahmedabad*

Punish the culprits so severely that others do not dare to do mischief against our state.

KRISHNA KALWAD, *Hubli*

We may not be able to get hold of all the terror outfits. What we can definitely do is fill up the cracks that let them sneak in. We must tighten our own security fast.

SANDIPTA MAHATO, *Kolkata*

Why are we not reacting to Pakistan in the same manner as the US? We have been a victim for the last 30 years. Do we really need the permission from the US as to how we should deal with terror?

SHEEMA SINGH, *Siliguri*

Please close the Nepal border and first catch internal traitors and spies. It should be our first step towards winning the War on Terror.

GOPAL KRISHNA C, *Chennai*